

Staying Online

Back in the '80s the Bee Gees crooned "Stayin' Alive". In today's parlance, this would be best said as "Stayin' Online"! Corny references apart, the fact is that being online and creating a strong web presence are the two most important things for personal and professional gains.

What is web presence? Is it just acquiring an e-mail address? Is it putting up a site? Is it your online conduct? As a matter of fact, it's all of these things and much more. It's almost like creating your identity online, like in the offline world.

Like in the real world, the internet also provides you various platforms to express yourself, interact, argue and learn. Some of these places can be found easily, others need you to be part of a network that is possible only after spending substantial amount of time with members of such networks. The advantages here are enormous.

Like with personal life, your professional life could also receive a major fillip with a good web presence. Being part of networking sites that are set up for professional reasons and even getting work online are ways of making proper use of your online identity.

But how does one do this? What is proper online conduct? How do I put up my site? Isn't it costly? Questions such as these must be running through your mind. Don't worry! We have attempted here to answer almost everything you may want to know. Don't miss the special tips spread across the book that tell you more about the topic at hand.

Topics in the book range from creating your web presence to how you can use it best to becoming members of forums, why to set up your own blog and how you can benefit from it.

What is the correct way to communicate? How should you compose e-mails? Is there a wrong way to do it? Yes, there is. Netiquettes (Etiquettes to be followed online) are crucial. Additionally, topics like setting up and designing your own Web site will enable you to create a professional web presence.

But remember, like in the real world, you are only as good as your reputation. Work hard at maintaining it. And you will be welcomed with open arms into the web world.